

Word family: **person / people / persons / peoples / personal / personally / personality**

Base word: person

Normal plural: people

Formal/legal plural: persons

Special plural: peoples

Related forms: personal, personally, personality

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / adjective (形容詞) / adverb (副詞)

Your sentence:

> “The ad showed ordinary **people** in stressful places.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **people** is the normal plural of **person**.

Meaning: Human beings considered individually or collectively; here, ordinary members of the public.

繁體中文: **一般的人們／普通大眾中的人, 而不是名人、專家或具有特殊身分的人**

中文翻譯:

「那則廣告呈現了身處壓力環境中的**普通人**。」

people = 多個人; 人們

1. **person = one individual human being (一個人) — 一名個別的人**

Meaning: One individual human being.

Practice 1

> “Only one **person** was waiting at the bus stop.”

「巴士站只有**一個人**在等候。」

Practice 2

> “She is the first **person** I ask when I need advice.”

「每當我需要意見時, 她都是我第一個會去問的**人**。」

****person = 單獨的一名人類個體****

2. ****people = plural of person (多個人) — 人們; 多人****

This is the meaning in your original sentence.

In normal everyday English:

* ****one person****

* ****two people****

* ****many people****

NOT normally ***two persons*** in ordinary conversation.

Practice 3 — Original

> “The ad showed ordinary ****people**** in stressful places.”

「那則廣告呈現了身處壓力環境中的****普通人們／一般人****。」

Practice 4

> “Hundreds of ****people**** attended the event.”

「數百****人****參加了這項活動。」

Practice 5

> “Some ****people**** prefer working from home.”

「有些****人****較喜歡在家工作。」

****people = person 最常用的複數形式, 表示兩個或以上的人****

3. ****people = people in general / the public (一般人／大眾) — 人們; 普羅大眾****

****Meaning:**** People considered generally as members of society, rather than a specific set of individuals.

Practice 6

> “**People** are becoming more concerned about online privacy.”

「**大眾／人們**愈來愈關注網上私隱。」

Practice 7

> “The campaign was designed to encourage **people** to use public transport.”

「這項宣傳活動旨在鼓勵**一般大眾**使用公共交通。」

****people = 泛指社會中的人們或一般大眾****

This is related to #2, but here ****people**** is not about counting particular individuals; it refers broadly to ****people in society****.

4. ****people = inhabitants of a place (某地方的居民) — 居民; 當地人****

****Meaning:**** The people who live in a particular town, region, or country.

Practice 8

> “The ****people**** of the village welcomed the visitors.”

「這條村的****居民****歡迎來訪者。」

Practice 9

> “Local ****people**** opposed the proposed development.”

「****當地居民****反對這項發展建議。」

****people = 居住在某個特定地方的一群居民****

5. ****a people = nation/ethnic community (民族／具有共同文化身分的群體) — 一個民族; 一個族群****

This is a genuinely different use of ****people****.

Here, ****people**** is a ****countable singular collective noun****:

> ****a people****

****Meaning:**** A national, ethnic, cultural, or historical community regarded as one group.

Practice 10

> “They are a ****people**** with a long cultural tradition.”

「他們是一個擁有悠久文化傳統的****民族／族群****。」

Practice 11

> “The constitution recognizes them as a distinct ****people****.”

「憲法承認他們是一個具有獨特身分的****民族群體****。」

****a people = 具有共同民族、文化、歷史或身分的一整個群體****

Notice:

> ****people are waiting outside****

> = 外面有很多人在等候。

But:

> ****a people with a shared history****

> = 一個擁有共同歷史的民族。

Very different grammar and meaning.

6. ****peoples = several distinct nations/ethnic groups (多個民族／族群) — 各民族; 多個族群****

****Peoples**** is NOT the normal plural meaning “many persons.”

It is the plural of ****a people**** in sense #5.

Practice 12

> “The region is home to many different ****peoples****.”

「這個地區是許多不同****民族／族群****的家園。」

Practice 13

> “The museum explores the cultures of Indigenous **peoples**.”

「博物館探討不同原住**民族／族群**的文化。」

peoples = 多個彼此具有不同民族、文化或歷史身分的群體

So:

* **100 people** = 一百個人

* **many peoples** = 多個民族

This distinction is extremely important.

7. **persons** = people in formal/legal/official language (正式／法律用語中的多人) — 人士；人員；若干人

Meaning: A formal plural of **person**, especially in laws, regulations, notices, reports, or official descriptions.

Practice 14

> “Unauthorized **persons** are not permitted to enter.”

「未經授權的**人士**不得進入。」

Practice 15

> “The vehicle can carry a maximum of six **persons**.”

「該車輛最多可載六名**人士／乘客**。」

persons = 在正式、法律或行政語境中表示多名個別人士

In ordinary conversation, we normally say:

> “Six **people** were in the car.”

rather than:

> “Six **persons** were in the car.”

8. **person** = grammatical person (文法上的人稱) — 第一／第二／第三人稱中的「人稱」

This is an important academic/grammar meaning.

Practice 16

> “‘I’ is a first-**person** pronoun.”

「‘I’ 是**第一人稱**代名詞。」

Practice 17

> “The story is written in the third **person**.”

「這個故事以**第三人稱**寫成。」

person = 文法上用來區分說話者、聽話者及其他人／事物的人稱類別

For example:

* **first person** → 第一人稱: I / we

* **second person** → 第二人稱: you

* **third person** → 第三人稱: he / she / it / they

9. **person** = legal entity with rights/duties (法律上的人) — 法律主體; 具有法律權利義務的人或實體

In legal English, **person** does not always mean a biological human being.

Depending on the law, a **person** can include companies or other legal entities.

Practice 18

> “A company may be treated as a legal **person**.”

「公司在法律上可以被視為具有權利和義務的**法律主體／法人**。」

Practice 19

> “The law applies to both natural and legal **persons**.”

「這項法律適用於**自然人及法人／法律實體**。」

****legal person = 法律承認可以擁有權利及承擔義務的個人或組織實體****

Useful distinction:

* ****natural person**** = 自然人／真正的人類個體

* ****legal person**** = 法人／法律人格實體

10. ****in person = physically present (本人親自到場) — 親自; 本人到場****

This is a very common fixed expression worth learning.

Practice 20

> “You need to sign the document ****in person****.”

「你需要****本人親自到場****簽署文件。」

Practice 21

> “We finally met ****in person**** after months of video calls.”

「經過幾個月視像通話後，我們終於****親身見面****。」

****in person = 本人實際到場，而不是透過電話、網絡或由別人代辦****

11. ****personal = belonging specifically to an individual (個人擁有／使用的) — 個人的; 私人所有的****

****Meaning:**** Belonging to or intended for one particular individual.

Practice 22

> “Please keep your ****personal**** belongings with you.”

「請隨身保管你的****個人物品****。」

Practice 23

> “Employees should not use company equipment for ****personal**** purposes.”

「員工不應把公司設備用於****私人用途****。」

****personal = 屬於某個特定個人或供其私人使用, 而不是公共／公司用途的****

12. ****personal = private life/information (私人生活／資料) — 私人的; 涉及個人隱私的****

****Meaning:** Relating to someone's private life, feelings, circumstances, or information.**

Practice 24

> “That is a very ****personal**** question.”

「那是一個****涉及私人生活、相當私密的問題****。」

Practice 25

> “Never share sensitive ****personal**** information online.”

「不要在網上分享敏感的****個人資料****。」

****personal = 涉及某人的私人生活、感受、身分或隱私資料的****

13. ****personal = based on your own opinion/experience (個人觀點／經驗) — 個人的; 主觀屬於自己的****

****Meaning:** Based on your own individual opinion, preference, experience, or judgment.**

Practice 26

> “That is just my ****personal**** opinion.”

「那只是我的****個人意見****。」

Practice 27

> “Her decision was based on ****personal**** experience.”

「她的決定是基於自己的****個人經歷****。」

****personal = 屬於某個人自己的觀點、偏好、經驗或判斷, 而非客觀共同標準****

14. **personal** = directed specifically at an individual (針對某個人本身) — 針對個人的

Meaning: Directed toward one particular person rather than their ideas, actions, or role.

Practice 28

> “The criticism became too **personal**.”

「那些批評變得過分**針對個人本身**，而不只是針對事情。」

Practice 29

> “Try not to take the comment as a **personal** attack.”

「盡量不要把那句評論理解成**針對你個人的攻擊**。」

personal = 直接針對某個人本身，而不是只針對其工作、觀點或行為

15. **personally** = from my own point of view (表達個人意見) — 就我個人而言；我個人認為

Practice 30

> “**Personally**, I prefer the simpler design.”

「**就我個人而言**，我較喜歡簡單一點的設計。」

Practice 31

> “I **personally** think the first advertisement was more effective.”

「**我個人認為**第一則廣告更有效。」

personally = 從說話者自己的個人觀點或偏好來說

16. **personally** = by the person himself/herself (本人親自) — 親自地；由本人直接

Meaning: Done directly by the particular person rather than through someone else.

Practice 32

> “The manager **personally** answered the complaint.”

「經理**親自**回覆了這宗投訴。」

Practice 33

> “She **personally** supervised the project.”

「她**本人親自**監督這個專案。」

personally = 由某人本人直接做, 而不是交給其他人代辦

17. **personality** = characteristic way a person thinks/behaves (性格) — 個性; 性格

Meaning: The combination of characteristics that makes someone behave, think, and interact in a particular way.

Practice 34

> “She has a warm and friendly **personality**.”

「她有**溫暖友善的性格**。」

Practice 35

> “Their personalities are completely different.”

「他們的**性格特質**完全不同。」

personality = 構成一個人典型思考、感受及行為方式的一組性格特徵

18. **personality** = strong/distinctive character (鮮明個性／魅力) — 個性魅力; 鮮明特色

Meaning: A noticeable, distinctive, or engaging character.

Practice 36

> “The presenter has a lot of **personality**.”

「那位主持人很有**鮮明的個性和個人魅力**。」

Practice 37

> “The room needs more **personality**.”

「這個房間需要更多**鮮明特色和個性**。」

Here, even a room or design can have **personality** figuratively.

personality = 令人感受到鮮明、獨特而有辨識度的個性或特色

Very important: **person / people / persons / peoples**

This is one of the most useful distinctions in the whole family.

Form	Basic use	
-----	-----	
person	一個人	
people	多個人(正常複數)	
persons	多名人士(正式／法律用語)	
a people	一個民族／族群	
peoples	多個民族／族群	

Compare:

> “One **person** entered the room.”

> 「一個人進入房間。」

> “Ten **people** entered the room.”

> 「十個人進入房間。」

> “No unauthorized **persons** may enter.”

> 「未經授權人士不得進入。」

> “They are a distinct **people**.”

> 「他們是一個獨特的民族。」

> “The region contains many Indigenous **peoples**.”

> 「這個地區有多個原住民族群。」

Important distinction: **people** vs **public**

people

Broadly means human beings or members of society.

> “Many **people** use this service.”

「很多**人**使用這項服務。」

the public

Means the community considered collectively, especially in relation to an organization, government, business, etc.

> “The museum is open to the **public**.”

「博物館向**公眾**開放。」

So **people** and **the public** are not always interchangeable.

Important distinction: **personal** vs **private**

They overlap, but:

personal

= specifically connected with an individual

> “personal opinion”

> = 個人意見

private

= not intended to be publicly known or accessed

> “private conversation”

> = 私人、不公開的談話

Something can be **personal** without necessarily being secret.

Important distinction: **person** vs **personnel**

These are often confused.

person

= one human being

personnel

= the employees/staff of an organization

> “Security **personnel** arrived quickly.”

「保安**人員**很快到場。」

⚠ **personnel** does **not** mean “many persons” in general.

It specifically refers to **staff / employees / members of an organization**.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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person	單獨的一名人類個體
people — plural persons	person 最常用的普通複數形式, 表示多個人
people — general public	泛指社會中的一般人們或大眾
people — inhabitants	居住於某個特定地方的一群居民
a people	具有共同民族、文化、歷史或身分的一個族群
peoples	多個彼此不同的民族或文化族群
persons	在正式、法律或行政語境中所指的多名個別人士
person — grammar	區分說話者、聽話者及其他對象的文法人稱
legal person	法律承認可享有權利並承擔義務的個人或組織實體
in person	本人實際親自到場, 而非透過其他方式
personal — belongings/use	屬於某個特定個人或供其私人使用的
personal — private matters	涉及個人生活、身分、感受或隱私資料的
personal — opinion/experience	屬於某人自己觀點、偏好、經驗或判斷的
personal — directed at someone	直接針對某個人本身, 而不只是事情的
personally — opinion	從自己個人的觀點或偏好來說
personally — directly	由某人本人直接進行, 而非由別人代辦
personality — character	構成一個人典型思想、感受及行為方式的性格特徵
personality — distinctive character	鮮明、獨特而有辨識度的個性或特色

| ****personnel****

| 某機構或組織的員工／工作人員

|

For your original sentence

> “The ad showed ordinary ****people**** in stressful places.”

The exact meaning is:

****people = person 的一般複數形式, 表示多個人; 在這裡尤其指普通大眾中的一般人****

So:

****ordinary people = 沒有特殊身分、名氣或突出地位的一般普通人****